Chandragupta, and which continued to receive royal attention during the reign of Ashoka, is the availability of water. Presumably it was required for cultivation, as drinking water, and for the other usual purposes. So, was there a large town here? Where was it located? And why did the administration decide to build an embankment rather than, for instance, dig wells?

Where the Mauryan town was situated is not known. It could well have been in the area of the Chamunda locality of modern Junagadh, where the accumulation of habitation deposits in a mound-like formation is visible over the hillside in its vicinity, and on the outer edge of the fortifications in what is known as Uparkot. The present residents of Chamunda are known to find sculptural relics, pottery, stone artefacts, and even skeletons where they stay. This area is also not far from what must have been one edge of the lake that came to be formed behind the dam. Why a dam-like embankment was constructed here has to do with the suitability of a large bowl-like space that is naturally available in this hill-encircled basin, the only exit being the Sonarekha (sometimes called Suvarnarekha) river. Perhaps the creation of an embankment-dependent water management system may also have had something to do with the limitations of well technology in Mauryan times. It is unlikely that this technology was capable of plumbing the depths at which water was to be found, for in city areas and their environs water is usually found at a great depth. The elaborate historic ‘vavas’ or wells there, all constructions of the medieval centuries, go very deep. The Adi-Chadi Vava in Uparkot has a depth, from top to bottom, of some 41 metres. Such deep wells were unknown in Mauryan times. Taxila provides an example: the height of the Bhir plateau on which the city stood made it impractical to dig wells. The residents therefore got their water from the Tamra nala, a rivulet which flowed outside the city area.[10] In Junagadh the Sonarekha river perhaps fulfilled a similar function.